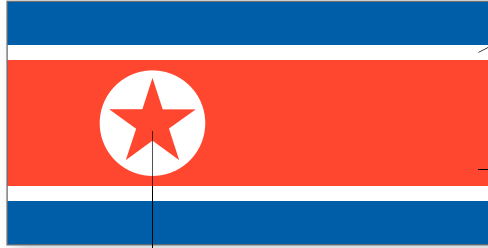


North Korea

Ratio: 1:2 **Adopted:** September 9, 1948 **Usage:** National and Civil

Two blue stripes stand for sovereignty, peace and friendship



The white stripes symbolize purity

Red represents communist revolution

The star is a symbol of communism

Asia



The Kingdom of Korea was annexed by Japan in 1910. In 1948, the peninsula was partitioned into democratic South and communist **North Korea**.

The flag was adopted in 1948, when North Korea became an independent communist state. The traditional Korean flag was red, white and blue. The regime retained these colors—with more prominence given to the red—and added a red star on a white disc. The disc recalls the Chinese yin-yang symbol, which is found on the

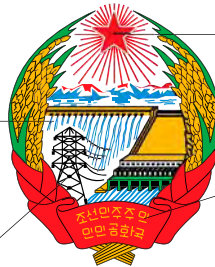
flag of South Korea, and represents the opposing principles of nature. The red stripe expresses revolutionary traditions; while the red star is for communism.

The prominent theme of the Soviet-style coat of arms is industrialization, depicted with an electricity pylon and a large dam.

ARMS OF NORTH KOREA

A hydroelectric power station within a wreath of rice-ears

Industrial elements feature heavily on the arms of Korea and include a large dam and electricity pylon



The star of communism

The inscription on the scroll is the country's official name—The Democratic People's Republic of Korea